

Combo Manager: Quick Start

Combo Manager keeps the semester's combos, makes the show calendar, and handles swaps. Everything is done by clicking: there is nothing to type in.

1. Install it (once per computer)

- **Windows:** unzip the download and double-click **Combo Manager.exe**. If Windows says "*Windows protected your PC*": click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
- **Mac:** unzip it, drag **Combo Manager** into **Applications** and double-click it. If the Mac won't open it: **System Settings > Privacy & Security > Open Anyway**.
- The first time, it asks for the **data folder**. Click **Choose existing folder** and pick **ComboManagerData**: the folder shared with you in OneDrive (Microsoft 365). Everything is kept there, so every computer sees the same combos and schedule. After that it opens straight away.

2. Collect the combos (Combos tab, as sign-ups come in)

1. Approve or reject sign-ups in Outlook, as they arrive.
2. Click **Sync** to bring the approved combos in. To add one by hand: right-click > **New combo**.
3. Click **Check combos** and fix what it lists.

Repeat whenever new sign-ups arrive: checking as you go catches problems (a typo'd email, a missing member) while they're easy to fix.

To change a combo or a person, right-click it. Changes show in blue until you click **Confirm changes**.

3. Make the schedule (once, after sign-ups close)

1. **Semester** tab: set the semester name, the first and last show day, the show nights and venues, the days off and the rules, following the academic calendar and the venue bookings. Each setting is explained next to it. Click **Save**.
2. **Schedule** tab: click **Make schedule** and wait a minute.
3. Click **Open PDF** for the calendar, and on the Combos tab **Open PDF** for the combo list. Send them out.
4. Tick **Lock schedule**, so it can't be remade by accident.

4. During the semester

- **A combo can't make a show** — on the **Swaps** tab, pick the combo and the show, pick an option, click **Add this change**, then **Confirm changes**. **Copy swap summary** gives you an email for the liaisons.
- **An open set** — on the **Schedule** tab, right-click the set: **Fill set...** to give it to a combo, or **Add text...** (e.g. *Jam session*).
- **Emails for a night** — on the **Schedule** tab, right-click the night, **Copy all emails**, paste into Outlook.
- **Undo a change that's already saved** — on the **Schedule** tab, click **Earlier versions...**

A dot after a tab's name means changes there aren't saved yet. The PDF and Excel files update by themselves.

5. If something goes wrong

- Read the message in the results box: it says what to fix.
- Still stuck? **About** tab > **Open the log**, and email that file to Elliott.
- Every few weeks: **Settings** tab > **Backup...**, and keep the zip somewhere safe.
- New computer: install it (step 1) and choose the same data folder.